

Prakruthi Chandra R

Founding Engineer | Ex- Senior Software Engineer

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- I'm a seasoned software engineer and technical founder with over nine years of experience building scalable distributed systems across startups and enterprise environments. Most recently, I served as the Technical Co-Founder and Founding Engineer of a next-gen automated news platform, where I led the end-to-end development of a product that reimagines how users interact with news using LLMs, intelligent agents, and distributed architecture.
- At the intersection of engineering and product, I built from scratch—owning everything from frontend/backend development to infrastructure. I worked hands-on with technologies like Java Spring Boot, AWS, OAuth 2.0, LLMs, and third-party APIs to deliver a fast, adaptable MVP in a highly iterative, user-centric environment. The product emphasized intelligent agent-driven workflows to curate real-time news with minimal user friction.
- Before that, I contributed to complex system redesigns at Citi as a Senior Software Engineer, where I helped transform a monolithic Ecomm Trade Surveillance System into a streamlined microservices architecture. This work significantly reduced processing times, improving compliance responsiveness and operational efficiency. My expertise spans Java, Spring Boot, AWS, Hadoop, and API development—focused on delivering scalable, high-performance backend systems.
- Whether at a high-growth startup or a large financial institution, I bring a deep curiosity, product thinking, and an iterative mindset—shipping quickly, learning fast, and building with purpose.

Core Skills: Technical Leadership · LLMs & Agentic AI · Distributed Systems · Java · Spring Boot · AWS · Microservices Architecture · API Design · Startups · Product Development · System Redesigns · Bootstrapping

Work Experience

Technical Co-Founder | Founding Engineer

Current Trends | London - Jan 2025 - Present

- As the technical co-founder of a light-touch automated news platform, I led the end-to-end development of a next-generation product combining distributed systems, LLMs, and intelligent agents. I worked across the entire technology stack—from frontend and backend development to infrastructure—using Java Spring Boot, AWS, OAuth 2.0, and third-party API integrations, LLM's and Agents
- Driven by a deep curiosity and passion for innovation, I played a dual role across engineering and product. This included engaging with early users, shaping the product roadmap, and rapidly iterating to define and deliver a viable MVP. My approach emphasized speed, experimentation, and adaptability—shipping quickly, learning fast, and refining continuously.

- My work involved architecting intelligent workflows powered by agents and language models, aiming to reimagine how users interact with and consume news. I thrived in a fast-paced, ambiguous environment where building, breaking, and learning was part of the process.

Career Break

London - Aug 2024 Jan 2025

Senior Software Engineer

Citi | London - May 2021 Jul 2024

I contributed to CITI Bank's strategic eComm Surveillance project CA-Engine as a Senior backend Engineer. The purpose of eComm surveillance was to analyze the electronic communications of citi employees that happen in the form of emails and IM's and identify potential wrong behaviors in their action like insider traits, use of unapproved channels, market abuse etc

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS:

- Spearheaded the migration of monolithic applications to microservice-based architecture. Leveraging advanced technologies like Apache Spark, Java, Python and Batch/Stream Processing thereby significantly Improving system scalability and maintainability.
- Developed and implemented production-grade features for enhancing the surveillance across data pipeline using ML models, Rule and Classifier based feature extractions.
- Optimized data processing workflows, significantly reducing processing time and resource utilization of the surveillance pipeline by employing parallel processing and cloud technologies including AWS S3,EC2 and API Gateway.
- Utilized containerization and orchestration technologies like Docker and Terraform for streamlined deployment and management
- Worked cross-functionally with engineering leads, product owners, and support teams to ensure stable production deployments and operational excellence. I ensured the seamless processing of current production runs without any backlogs.
- Mentored junior developers and led code quality initiatives through peer reviews, SOLID design principles, refactoring, and TDD practices.

Software Engineer

Dell EMC | Bengaluru - Feb 2018 Mar 2021

Developed and maintained features for 'Virtual Storage Integrator, a plugin for VMware vCenter, involving CRUD

operations on RDM Disks, VOL, VMFS

Full-stack contributor using Angular front-end and Java & Jooby microservices back-end

Improved code maintainability and testability by promoting TDD and served as Subject Matter Expert for JUnit

testing

Implemented best practices across the development lifecycle, improving system resilience and modularity

Software Engineer

Cognizant | Bengaluru - Jan 2016 Feb 2018

- Delivered multiple enterprise web applications for clients including PepsiCo, health care clients like Horizon BCBSNJ and Excellus
- Developed RESTful APIs and managed backend logic for HR portals, insurance modules, and customer data management tools pipelines
- Maintained 80% unit test coverage, participated in Agile ceremonies, and ensured robust production deployment

Skills

- **Core Skills**
 - Technical Leadership · LLMs & Agentic AI · Distributed Systems · Product Development · Startups · System Redesigns · Bootstrapping · Stakeholder Collaboration · Team Mentoring
- **Backend Development**
 - Java (11/17) · Spring Boot · REST APIs · Microservices Architecture · API Design · Spring Security
 - OAuth2 · JWT · Event-Driven Architecture · Fault-Tolerant Design · Clean & Maintainable Code
- **Cloud & DevOps**
 - Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, SQS, SNS) · Cloud Expert
 - Infrastructure as Code: Terraform · Kubernetes · Docker
 - CI/CD: Jenkins · GitLab · Bitbucket
- **Monitoring & Testing:**
 - TDD · Integration Testing · Agile Delivery
 - Datadog
- **Messaging & Event Streaming**
 - Apache Kafka · RabbitMQ · Event-Driven Systems · Event-Driven Development
- **Frontend & UI**
 - Angular · TypeScript
- **Data & Analytics**
 - SQL · Apache Hive · Apache Spark

Education

Visvesvaraya Technological University -
Jan 2010 Jan 2014

Bachelors Electronics & Communication
GPA: 8 | Topper of College in Year 2

Languages
English (*fluent*)

Certificates
OCJP, United Kingdom
Oracle

